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'The hour has come!'

....Zambia votes with a clear battle-line drawn between Hichilema and Mundubile

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Chaminuka CEO killers nabbed

By Alex Maboshe

Seven unnamed individuals suspected to be behind the murder and aggravated robbery of Chaminuka Resort Chief Executive Officer Stelios Sardinis, 64 have been arrested.

Police Spokesperson Godfrey Chilabi confirmed that four of the suspects were detained earlier, while three more were arrested yesterday in Lusaka.

All seven are Lusaka residents and remain in police custody.

Mr. Chilabi said investigations are ongoing to determine the full circumstances of the incident and the involvement of each suspect.

He urged the public not to ascribe political motives to the case in the absence of verified information, emphasising that it is a serious criminal investigation involving the loss of life.

He also cautioned against circulating rumours or unverified claims, particularly on social media, warning that such actions could hinder the probe and cause additional distress to the deceased's family.



Brian Mundubile



President Hakainde Hichilema

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Real News in Real Time

By Alex Maboshe

A 27-year-old man has died in Sinda District weeks after he was allegedly assaulted with a pan brick during a drinking session at a tavern in Mwase Village.

The now deceased, Andrew Njobvu of Chief Kawaza's area, is alleged to have been attacked

Sinda brick-struck man dies

by his 23-year-old cousin, Martin Banda, on 22 July 2026.

Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba said the incident occurred around 19:00 hours while Njobvu and others were drinking beer at the tavern.

Banda allegedly quarreled with his father, 58-year-old Abia Banda, and the two began fighting. Njobvu and another cousin, Edward Maseko, intervened to separate them.

During the confrontation, Banda allegedly picked up a pan brick and struck Njobvu on the left cheek, causing him to fall and lose consciousness. Njobvu was taken to his uncle's home.

The matter was later reported to police, who issued a medical report form. He received treatment at Sinda Zonal Health Facility and returned home, but remained unwell for about two weeks.

After developing persistent headaches, he was taken to Sheketeni Mini Hospital.

On 9 August he was referred to St Francis Mission Hospital, where he was admitted.

Njobvu died at the hospital on 10 August 2026 at approximately 14:00 hours. The death was reported to Sinda Police the following day, 11 August, and a murder docket was opened.

Mr Mweemba said Banda has been arrested and is in police custody.

Njobvu's body is at St Francis Mission Hospital Mortuary pending a post-mortem examination to determine the exact cause of death.

44 confirmed dead in Zim Kariba accident

By Ruth Kambita

At least 44 people have died and dozens more rescued after a passenger ferry capsized on Lake Kariba yesterday, authorities said, in one of the worst inland-waterway disasters in Zimbabwe's recent history.

The RIDA ferry, which had a certified capacity of 95 (90 passengers and five crew), was reportedly carrying far more people when it was struck by a strong wave and overturned.

Police and the Zimbabwe Civil Protection Unit (CPU) gave differing initial tallies; the CPU said ticket records showed 114 adult passengers, while witnesses and officials reported children and other unregistered travelers were

also on board.

Seventy-seven people have been rescued so far, police said. Divers and rescue crews have recovered 44 bodies, up from an initial 15.

Search-and-rescue operations continued into today as teams worked to recover more victims and tow the vessel to Musamba Karuma Island to offload luggage and facilitate recovery efforts.

Zimbabwe's President Emmerson Mnangagwa declared a state of disaster to ensure "all necessary resources are mobilised" for the response.

Government reinforcements include an army boat squadron, a police sub-aqua unit and a privately owned helicopter.



ECZ Chairperson Mwangala Zaloumis shaking hands with ECZ Commissioner Mutiti Ndiyoi while looking on is ECZ Deputy Chairperson Brigadier General (RTD) Vincent Mukanda during the National Election Results Center official launch. Picture by Jean Mandela.

Loadshedding where?

By Alex Maboshe

Zesco has dismissed social media reports claiming that load shedding has resumed and that new load management schedules have been released.

Rose Sibisi, Zesco's Stakeholder Relations Manager, said the power utility has not

introduced any load management programme and has not issued any new load shedding schedules.

She explained that the schedule currently circulating online is an outdated 2024 document from a period when the country was implementing load management measures.

Presenting it as current information is therefore misleading.

Ms Sibisi urged the public to ignore the schedule and refrain from sharing unverified

information, warning that doing so could cause unnecessary anxiety and confusion among consumers.

She emphasised that any future changes affecting electricity supply will be officially announced through Zesco's recognised communication channels.

Customers experiencing power interruptions or technical faults are encouraged to report them directly to the utility.

ECZ sets election results centre

By Linda Nyondo

The Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) has launched a National Election Results Centre and said it is ready to facilitate an orderly, transparent and accurate announcement of the 2026 general election results.

ECZ chairperson Mwangala Zaloumis said the commission was committed to upholding accountability and that all results would be handled in accordance with established procedures.

"I am appealing to political parties and their repre-

sentatives to act in line with the law," Ms Zaloumis said.

She urged anyone who was dissatisfied with the outcome or who sought clarification to use the prescribed channels to raise their concerns.

Ms Zaloumis also appealed to politicians to

discharge their duties with integrity and to show mutual respect during this period of national anticipation.

"This is a period of great anticipation, not a time for unnecessary tension," she said, adding that the media were an integral partner in ensuring accurate information was disseminated.

"Avoid speculation. An inaccurate figure can spread across the country within minutes," she warned.

The chairperson cautioned the public to be wary of misinformation spread via artificial intelligence and social media platforms.

Ms Zaloumis described the launch of the results centre as evidence of the commission's commitment to the electoral process, saying the facility would bring together stakeholders from different walks of life.

The ECZ will provide free Wi-Fi to accredited stakeholders at the centre. It has also purchased transmission kits to relay results for the elections scheduled on 13 August 2026. Members of the public may follow announced results on the commission's official website.

'The hour has come!'

By Sam Phiri

Candidates have spoken and the electorate has heard them; now the hour of final decision has arrived for Zambia to choose who will lead the nation for the next five years.

It is no secret that this has become a two-horse race between incumbent President Hakainde Hichilema and former Mporokoso Member of Parliament Brian Mundubile.

As the country retires tonight, anxieties will rise; with dawn will come stress and other tensions depending on the outcome.

Many will celebrate, while others will face disappointment and distress, depending on which side they find themselves on.

President Hichilema undertook a final round of public engagements in Lusaka today alongside Vice-President Mutale Nalumango, offering last reminders to supporters.

As President of Zambia, Mr Hichilema appealed to citizens to protect the country's peace and stability by turning out to vote in tomorrow's general election, saying the ballot is crucial to sustaining the economic transformation his administration has recorded over the last five years.

He warned against hate speech and violence during the election period, and condemned reports that some

opposition figures had sent colleagues abroad for security training allegedly intended to destabilise Zambia.

"It is unacceptable for anyone to plan to cause confusion and violence; those engaging in such acts will be arrested and prosecuted," President Hichilema said.

The President reiterated his assurance that the election will be free and fair and urged all parties to respect the outcome.

"We have made tough decisions to put the economy on a stable path," he said, calling on voters to consider the progress achieved when casting their ballots.

By contrast, opposition candidate Brian Mundubile merely reminded voters to bring their own pens when they go to cast their votes tomorrow, without elaborating.

"As we count down to Election Day tomorrow, I'm sharing a light moment with my running mate, Makebi Zulu, as we vibe to some of our campaign songs," he said.

He acknowledged that the campaign had been intense but said the mission remained clear: a prosperous Zambia that works for everyone, leaving no one behind.

Tomorrow, the people will decide, and a new chapter will be written in the history of Zambia's democracy.

Eden students expelled for supporting HH?

By Linda Nyondo

The Zambia National Students' Union (ZANASU) has opened investigations into reports that seven Eden University students were expelled for taking part in a solidarity match supporting President Hakainde Hichilema's candidacy.

Programmes Officer Emmanuel Sakala said ZANASU has written to the Eden University students' union to

verify the reported expulsions. The union has also contacted Eden University management to seek confirmation and details.

"We are currently not in a position to either confirm or deny that these students have been expelled," he said. The union is seeking to establish the circumstances that led to the alleged expulsions.

Mr Sakala added that, if the expulsions are confirmed, proper student rights and

disciplinary procedures do not appear to have been followed. He emphasised that due process must be observed in any disciplinary action.

He also noted that no student has yet submitted a formal in-person complaint alleging expulsion. ZANASU has promised to publish the findings of its investigation once inquiries are complete.



ELECTORAL COMMISSION OF ZAMBIA

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE OF POLLING DAY

The Electoral Commission of Zambia wishes to inform stakeholders and the general public that **Thursday, 13th August 2026** is **Polling Day for the 2026 General Election**, in accordance with Article 56 of the Constitution of Zambia.

All duly registered voters are encouraged to exercise their constitutional right by casting their vote at their designated polling stations.

The Commission wishes to remind all voters to carry the following documents when going to vote:

- **Green National Registration Card (NRC);** and
- **Voter's Card.**

Polling stations throughout the country will be open from **06:00 hours to 18:00 hours**.

The Commission further appeals to all stakeholders, Political Parties, Candidates, Observers, Monitors, the Media, Civil Society Organisations and members of the public to conduct themselves in a peaceful, orderly and law-abiding manner before, during and after polling. The Commission urges all citizens to uphold the values of peace, tolerance and respect for the electoral process.

#Count Me In



Electoral Commission of Zambia



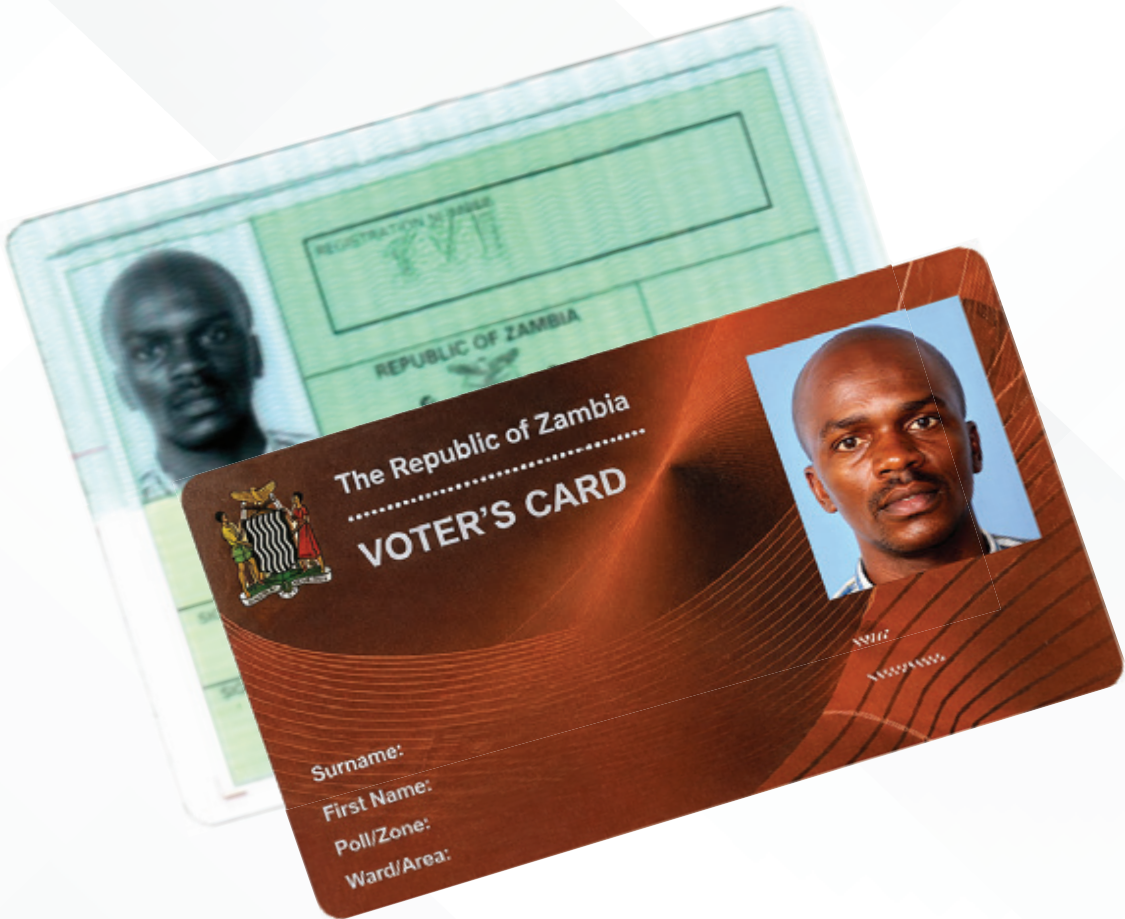
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KNOW THE DOCUMENTS YOU NEED TO BRING ON ELECTION DAY

- 1.Voter’s Card
- 2. National Registration Card (NRC)

Zambia Votes
13th August 2026

X



COUNT
ME IN

Kangwa, Notulu partner to win Midlands Pairs golf at Chilanga

By Benedict Tembo

Kangwa Muyunda and Notulu Muyunda won the Midlands Pairs Golf Tournament at Chilanga Golf Club over the weekend. Kangwa and Notulu carded 72 points to emerge overall winners of the 36-hole tournament. Beatrice Muzhiya and Martha Busaka rallied in second position on 71 points. Muzhiya said it was not easy to be runners-up while playing away from their own course, Mazabuka Golf Club. "I was playing off 25 handicap and my partner (Martha Busaka) was playing off six handicap. I played my game and she, her game. She really played very well and I also played well such that we enjoyed our game," said Muzhiya, who thought they won.

Chisongo thrashes Tanzanian Kazoba in maiden Billy Jean tennis entry

By Benedict Tembo

In Zambia's first-ever appearance at the Billie Jean King Cup, Isabel Chisongo delivered a commanding 6-1, 6-1 victory over Tanzania's Alesi Kazoba in Ivory Coast yesterday. Zambia lead the tieTanzania 1-0. "A first match, a first victory. What a performance—composed, confident and dominant from start to finish. A new chapter in Zambian tennis history," the Zambia Tennis Association said in a statement. ZTA further congratulated Chisongo for giving Zambia a classic entry into the Billy Jean King Cup tennis series. "Now we rally behind Christabel Chisongo in the second singles match. Come on Zambia —Let's keep making history," a ZTA statement said.

"We played very well in the afternoon. We got two birdies and missed eagle and a number of pars," Muzhiya, who is the Mazabuka Golf Club Lady Captain, said. Busaka, the Mazabuka Golf Club Lady Vice-Captain said the experience was good. "I didn't actually think we would be part of the winning teams because I was playing off six handicap, but my partner's handicap was a relief as she was playing off 25. Overall, it was a good day for me and my partner, I played well and she supported so well," Busaka, who remembered missing an eagle on hole number nine, said. They had two birdies, one in the first round and another in the second round with a number of pars here and there. "It felt good especially on a course away from home," she said.

We are both from Mazabuka Golf Club where I am the Vice-Captain Administration and my partner is the Lady Captain. Mary Phiri and Tomaïda Zulu were afternoon winners with 32 points while Angala Banda and Beatrice Zulu emerged runners-up on 27 points. Michelo Milimo and Docus Habenzu were the morning winners with 43 points with Sandra Bulaya and Nyalela Sumani being the runners up on 40 points.

The nearest to the pin accolade went to the pair of Mutinta Hamunji and Astridah Moonga. For dressing like models, Mwamba Mwangata and Tamara Mwale were voted the best dressed pair. Chainama Hills Golf Club Lady Captain Nyamvuyu Bulaya said the Midlands Pairs was significant for ladies in the Southern Region because it gave them an opportunity to compete, build partnerships and strengthen friendships among golfers from different clubs. "It promotes teamwork, confidence and learning from one another, while creating a platform for the growth and visibility of ladies' golf in Zambia," Bulaya said.

Zambia drawn in Group C in COSAFA U20 AFCON qualifier tournament



The Zambia Under-20 Men's National Team has been drawn in Group C for the 2026 CAF U-20 Africa Cup of Nations Qualifiers in the Cosafa Zone. Zambia will face Malawi, Comoros and Botswana at the tournament which will run from 18-27 September in Mauritius. The tournament will serve as a qualifier for the Africa Cup of Nations which will take place in Ghana

next year. Top two teams in the tournament will qualify for the AFCON. Meanwhile Group A has hosts Mauritius, Mozambique, Namibia and Seychelles. In Group B has defending champions South Africa, Angola, Eswatini and Lesotho. Group winners will automatically qualify to the semifinals while the fourth spot will go to the third

best placed team across the three groups. The Perry Mutapa coached U20 squad will be looking to not just clinch a ticket to the AFCON but hope to take Zambia back to the FIFA World Cup. Zambia are record 12-time Cosafa u-20 champions and were at the last AFCON in 2025 under the tutelage of Boyd Mulwanda. FAZ

Perry's U-20 in Malawi, Comoros COSAFA, WAFCON tests

By Benedict Tembo

The Zambia Under-20 youth soccer team has been drawn in Group 'C' to contend with Malawi in next month's COSAFA African youth cup qualifiers. Apart from neighbours Malawi, coach Perry

Mutapa's Zambia youth team will also have to fight it out with Comoros and Botswana for qualifiers will be held from September 18–27. The draw comes hardly a week after FAZ appointed Mutapa and his technical bench for the humongous tripartite qualifier series. Mutapa, an ex- Zambia international is currently

coach for Super FAZ League side Green Eagles. It will Mutapa's first assignment to lead the Under-20 to the COSAFA tournament. The regional tournament will also be qualifiers for the TotalEnergies AFCON finals and a step towards the qualifiers for the FIFA Under-20 World Cup.